

FILING CHECKLIST

For: Marcus J. Williams — Norfolk, VA

Follow these steps to file your Answer with the court. Check off each item as you complete it.

■ Step 1: Review Your Packet

Read through all documents. Make sure your name, case number, and all information is correct.

■ Step 2: Sign the Answer Form

Sign and date your Answer form where indicated. Use blue or black ink.

■ Step 3: Make Copies

Make at least 3 copies of EVERY document in your packet. Keep one copy for yourself.

■ Step 4: File with the Court Clerk

Take the original + 2 copies to the courthouse where your case was filed. Ask the clerk to stamp all copies as 'Filed' and keep a stamped copy.

■ Step 5: Check Filing Fee (or File Fee Waiver)

Ask the clerk about the filing fee. If you cannot afford it, submit your fee waiver form (included in this packet) at the same time.

■ Step 6: Serve the Landlord

You must deliver a copy of your filed Answer to the landlord or their attorney. Keep proof of delivery (certified mail receipt, hand-delivery receipt, or email confirmation).

■ Step 7: Note Your Deadline

Your response deadline: You must appear on the return date shown on your summons. Mark this date on your calendar.

■ Step 8: Prepare for Hearing

If a hearing is scheduled, bring all your documents, evidence, and your hearing script (included in this packet). Review it beforehand.

■ Step 9: Attend All Court Dates

Arrive 15 minutes early. If you miss a court date, the judge may enter a default judgment against you.

■ Step 10: File Proof of Service

After serving the landlord, file a Certificate of Service or Proof of Service with the court. The e-filing instructions in this packet explain how.